

BRAND GUIDE, EDITION 2026

Saffron & Steam Coffee Co.

How we sound, what we say, and how we look.

Fictional demo brand

This brand, its products, people and numbers are invented for the Brand Gate hackathon demo. Any resemblance to a real company is coincidental.

01 INTRODUCTION

Who we are

Saffron & Steam Coffee Co. is an Indian specialty coffee brand. We began in Pune in 2019 with one small roaster and a simple idea: serve coffee that tastes of where it grew.

Today we work with partner estates in Karnataka and Kerala, roast in small batches, and serve guests in our cafes. Everything we publish should feel like a conversation at the counter: warm, unhurried and honest.

Our three beliefs

- **Craft first.** Talk about the bean, the roast and the brew before the price.
- **Be honest.** Say only what we can prove, and prove it with an approved fact.
- **Be welcoming.** Everyone who walks in, or scrolls past, is a guest.

How to use this guide

Every writer, designer and agency partner follows this guide. Before anything is published, it is checked against these pages and against our list of approved facts. Each rule below has a short statement you can quote back to a colleague.

> **Keep it on-brand.**
> This is the umbrella rule. When in doubt, ask what a warm, confident Saffron & Steam barista would say or show.

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02 HOW WE SOUND

Voice and tone

Our two tone words are **warm** and **confident**. We can be playful in small doses and formal in contracts, but we are never pushy and never sarcastic.

Our voice is warm and confident, like a friendly barista who knows the beans.

Warm means friendly and welcoming. Confident means we state what we know plainly, without hedging or boasting.

Never push, pressure or guilt a reader into buying.

No pressure tactics, no guilt, no shaming people who prefer another cup.

Never use sarcasm or mock our customers, other cafes or coffee habits.

Sarcasm reads as unfriendly, and it does not translate well across languages and cultures.

Use at most one exclamation mark per post and avoid words in ALL CAPS.

Enthusiasm should show in word choice, not in punctuation. A few brand terms such as MRP, UPI and T&C are fine in capitals.

Avoid inappropriate humour.

Humour should include everyone. Keep jokes gentle and about coffee, not about people.

Posts should feel premium.

Premium means calm, careful and well made. Think quiet confidence, not loud sales.

Tone at a glance

We are	We are not
Warm, welcoming, patient	Pushy, bossy, guilt-tripping
Confident, clear, specific	Boastful, vague, hedging
Gently playful	Sarcastic, mocking, edgy

03 TERMINOLOGY

Words we use and avoid

Consistent words make us recognisable and keep us out of trouble. Use the product names exactly as written here.

Our old product name Steam Classic is retired; always write Saffron Signature Roast.

Steam Classic was the name until early 2026. Any copy still using it is out of date.

Never use the words cheap, guaranteed, miracle, unbeatable or bargain.

These words promise things we cannot back up, or they make good coffee sound disposable. Say fairly priced or well made instead.

Write the brand name as Saffron & Steam Coffee Co. and never as S&S or saffron and steam.

The ampersand is part of our name. Use it in full, with capital letters on both words.

Product names

Product	What it is
Saffron Signature Roast	Our medium-roast house blend (formerly Steam Classic)
Monsoon Malabar	Monsooned arabica with a low-acid, heavy-bodied cup
Chikmagalur Estate Reserve	Single-estate lot, roasted lightly
Cold Steam Brew	Cold brew, steeped for 18 hours

Preferred phrasing

- Say **baristas** or **our team**, not staff or workers.
- Say **cafe**, not outlet or shop.
- Say **roasted this week** only when the roast date backs it up.

04 SAYING ONLY WHAT WE CAN PROVE

Claims and proof

People trust us because we are specific and honest. Every claim in a post must be backed by something our team has approved and can show.

Do not call us the best, the number one or the finest unless an approved fact with a source proves it.

Words like best, number one and finest are claims. Without a source they are opinions, and we do not publish them.

Every number, rating, award, price and sourcing claim must match a current approved fact.

Approved facts live in the facts list. Each fact has a source and a date until which it stays valid. Once a fact expires, stop using it.

Do not call our coffee organic, Fairtrade, sustainable or carbon neutral; we hold no such certification.

We source carefully and pay fairly, but we do not hold third-party certifications. Describe what we actually do instead.

What counts as a claim

- Numbers: cafe counts, ratings, review totals, farm prices, years.
- Awards, press mentions and rankings.
- Sourcing, roasting and sustainability statements.
- Prices, discounts, offers and shipping terms.

If you cannot find a fact

Ask the brand admin to add it, with a source. Do not guess a number, round it up or reuse last quarter's figure.

05 OFFERS, HEALTH AND COMPETITIONS

Promotions and legal

Offers and competitions are covered by consumer law. These rules protect our guests and us.

Do not invent urgency: no only today, last chance or hurry unless the offer really ends then.

Real deadlines are welcome. Pressure that has no real deadline behind it is not.

Every promotion must state its end date.

Give the date in full, for example valid till 15 November 2026, so guests know exactly when it ends.

Never make health or medical claims; coffee is a pleasure, not a treatment.

Do not say that coffee cures, treats, detoxes or prevents anything, and do not describe it as healthy. This is a legal rule, not only a style rule.

Every giveaway or contest post must carry the line T&C apply.

Place the line T&C apply at the end of the post, and keep the full terms on our website.

Quote prices in rupees, say that taxes are included, and match the approved price list.

Write Rs 495 incl. taxes. If the price on a post differs from the approved list, the post must wait.

Before you publish a promotion

- Is there a code, a price or a percentage? Check it against the approved facts.
- Is the end date written out? Check the calendar.
- Does it make a health claim, even indirectly? Remove it.

06 VISUAL IDENTITY

Colour, type and imagery

Our look is warm paper, dark coffee and a flash of saffron. The palette is small on purpose.

Use only the six palette colours; off-palette neon or gradients are not allowed.

Check every colour in an ad or PDF against the swatches below. Close matches are fine; neon and gradients are not.

Saffron Orange
#F28C28
Accents, buttons, highlights

Deep Coffee Brown
#3B2418
Text and logo

Cream
#FFF4E0
Backgrounds

Steam Grey
#B9B4AD
Dividers, secondary shapes

Cardamom Green
#4F6B3A
Labels, sustainability-neutral accents

Roast Terracotta
#B5482A
Warm highlights, sale tags

Set headings in Fraunces and body text in Inter; no other typefaces in PDFs.

Fraunces gives us warmth in titles. Inter keeps small text easy to read.

Fraunces SemiBold: Slow mornings, steady brews.

Inter Regular: Freshly roasted in Pune and brewed for you.

Imagery should feel authentic.

Use real people, real cafes and real beans wherever possible, and avoid heavy filters.

07 OUR EMBLEM

Using the logo



The emblem shows a steaming cup inside a saffron ring. It is the same on every surface.

Master file: **logo.png**. It is supplied by the brand admin and checked by Brand Gate against every image.

Always use the official logo file; never redraw, recolour, stretch or retype it.

Look-alikes are easy to spot: wrong cup shape, wrong typeface, wrong orange. If it was not exported from the master file, do not use it.

Keep a clear space around the logo and never place it on a busy background.

Leave a margin of at least ten percent of the logo width on every side, on a calm cream or flat saffron area.

Minimum size

Never print the logo smaller than 18 mm wide, or show it smaller than 96 pixels wide on screen. Below that, use the wordmark Saffron & Steam in Fraunces SemiBold Italic.

08 EVERYONE CAN READ US

Accessibility

Many of our guests use screen readers, large text or low-vision settings. Accessible content is good manners and good business.

Every image needs alt text that describes what it shows.

Describe the scene in one plain sentence, for example: Barista pouring hot water over ground coffee. Do not start with image of.

Text on images must have a contrast ratio of at least 4.5 to 1.

Deep coffee brown on cream passes comfortably. Saffron on white, and light grey on cream, do not.

More habits

- Write hashtags in CamelCase, such as #SlowMorningsSteadyBrews.
- Do not put essential information only in an image.
- Add captions or transcripts to video.
- Keep sentences short and words simple.

09 WHERE WE PUBLISH

Channel guidance

Each channel has its own rhythm and its own reading level. Shorter, plainer writing travels furthest.

Match reading level to the channel: Instagram grade 8, email and website grade 10, LinkedIn grade 12.

Reading level is measured with the Flesch-Kincaid grade. Plain language lets more people enjoy what we write.

Channel	Max grade	Notes
Instagram	8	Up to 120 words. Warm, visual, one idea.
Email	10	Clear subject line. One main offer.
Website	10	Product facts first. Tell the story second.
LinkedIn	12	Behind the scenes, sourcing, team and growth.

Each post carries one clear call to action, such as visit, order or subscribe.

Tell readers exactly one next step, and make it easy to take.

Do not be too salesy.

Lead with the coffee and the people. A reminder of an offer is fine; shouting about it is not.

Approval

Creators draft, reviewers check against this guide and the facts, and an approver signs off. Nobody approves their own work.